



Figure 10: Connecting to the emulator



Figure 11: The emulator running

Test the app using an Android phone

Testing with your Android phone is a lot easier if your phone has Wi-Fi and is connected wirelessly to the same network as your computer. Do follow the instructions for setting this up as given online. Once set up, to connect to the Android phone you have to launch the MIT App Inventor 2 Companion app in your phone. Then use **Connect->AI Companion** as shown in Figure 13.

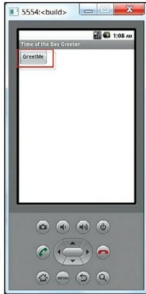


Figure 12: The GreetMe message app in your phone. Then use **Connect->AI Companion** as shown in Figure 13.

Doing so will show you a QR code and a 6-digit alphabetical code. You should either scan the QR code from your phone camera or enter the 6-digit code to connect to your App. You can then see the app running on your phone and should be able to hear the congratulatory message on your phone.

The logic behind the 'Time of the day greeter'

Now that we have seen our app executing, let us come back to the problem of the 'Time of the day greeter'. The pseudo-code for the time of the day goes like this, assuming the current time is in the 24-hours format:

```
if current time. hours <12 then greeting = 'Good morning'
else if current time. hours >=12 <18 then greeting = 'Good afternoon'
else if current time. hours >=18 <=21 then greeting = 'Good evening'
else greeting = 'Good night'
```

To collect the current time, we can use *Clock1.Hour*, which returns the hours component of the current time as a number. We have to supply an instant as a parameter for

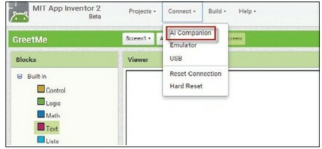


Figure 13: Connecting to AI Companion

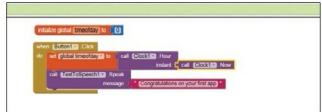


Figure 14: Variable set to hours from the current time

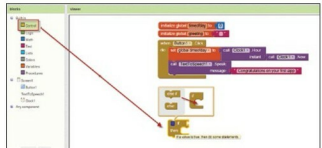


Figure 15: Configuring the 'if-then' block

this, and we can give *Clock1.Now* for the same. Let us create a global variable, *timeoftheday*, to store the time value so that we can use it multiple times when we put in the pseudo-code above. We have to initialise it to some value, and for this we drag a value field a 0 and plug it into the global definition. Another interesting thing is that once a variable is created you also have the setter and getter methods for the same, which are also available as blocks, which you can drag and use as the RHS or LHS of an assignment. You can see how the blocks look once we have assigned the *timeoftheday* variable to the hours as per the current time, as shown in Figure 14.

Let us now put in one more text variable to store the greeting as shown in the pseudo-code above.

To do this, we initialise an empty string from *Built-in->Text*. We now come to the most complicated part about the blocks and what could prove to be a bit frustrating if you do not know how to get it done. It has to do with the 'if then' block and adding multiple 'else if' blocks into it. To do this, click and select an 'if then' block from *Built-in->Control* and then, using the blue configure box, drop the multiple 'else-if' blocks needed into the configuring box area itself,